



Foreign student ban at Harvard is blocked

Judge temporarily halts Trump tactic to limit college’s admissions

BY SUSAN SVRLUGA

A federal judge in Massachusetts on Friday blocked the Trump administration’s effort to ban international students from Harvard University, an unprecedented tactic by the federal government as it tries to exert control over some of the nation’s most elite campuses.

Harvard filed a lawsuit Friday morning after the Department of Homeland Security revoked the school’s certification to enroll international students. The government said Thursday that foreign students must transfer from the university or risk losing their visa status, escalating President Donald Trump’s pitched battle with the Ivy League school.

“Today’s ruling delays justice and seeks to kneecap the President’s constitutionally vested powers under Article II,” DHS Assistant Secretary Tricia McLaughlin said in an email. “It is a privilege, not a right, for universities to enroll foreign students and benefit from their higher tuition payments to help pad their multibillion-dollar endowments; that fact hasn’t changed.” She said the Trump administration is committed to “restoring common sense to our student visa system, and we expect a higher court to vindicate us in this. We have the law, the facts, SEE HARVARD ON A5

Columbia: Jewish students’ rights were flouted, government says. **A5**

Top lawyer at ATF opposed move to allow gun device

Counsel told DOJ that ‘forced reset triggers’ should remain off-limits

BY PERRY STEIN

When Robert Leider became chief counsel at the Bureau of Alcohol, Tobacco, Firearms and Explosives in March, agency employees briefed him about a controversial device known as a “forced reset trigger,” according to people familiar with the discussions. The device allows semi-automatic weapons to fire more rapidly, and ATF had classified them as machine guns, effectively making them illegal.

That classification was challenged in court, with gun owners and manufacturers represented by legal teams that included David Warrington, who has since become President Donald Trump’s White House counsel. Now the Trump administration was considering reversing the Biden-era classification.

In a bid to explain the classification, ATF workers took Leider to a shooting range to see how the triggers operate, according to people familiar with the outing, who like others interviewed spoke on the condition of anonymity because they feared retribution. At the end of the process, SEE TRIGGERS ON A8

Reporting for duty



STEPHANIE SCARBROUGH/AP

Graduates of the U.S. Naval Academy toss their caps during Friday’s ceremonies in Annapolis, Maryland, where Vice President JD Vance during his commencement address urged them to “lead the way” in a changing world.

Kremlin’s latest line of attack: Fiber-optic drones

BY SIOBHÁN O’GRADY, KOSTIANTYN KHUDOV AND SERHII KOROLCHUK

SUMY, UKRAINE — Ukrainian soldiers had grown used to the deadly drones stalking their vehicles and chasing them through doors and windows — until they met ones they couldn’t stop.

New drones were swarming the battlefield and didn’t rely on jammable radio signals like the older, simpler models — these

Cable-tethered devices that foil signal jamming have Ukraine scrambling

were controlled instead by tiny cables as thin as thread stretching back to the operator.

For months, Russia has ramped up its deployment of fiber-optic drones, which are

steered by the same data-transporting cables made of glass that revolutionized high-speed internet access. While the cables can occasionally tangle, cutting off the signal, they also give the weapon a major advantage because they cannot be disrupted by jamming systems.

Russian troops have used the weapons, which have a range of up to 12 miles, to destroy Ukrainian equipment and control key logistics routes, particularly in

Russia’s western Kursk region, where Ukrainian troops say the new technology contributed to their recent painful retreat.

Russia’s fiber-optic drones, which have a longer battery life and more-precise targeting than wireless models, vastly outnumbered Ukraine’s drones on the battlefield in Kursk, giving Russia SEE UKRAINE ON A16

Prisoner swap: Ukrainian POWs return to anxious families. **A10**

Trump aims at Apple and E.U.

THREATENS TO ROLL OUT NEW TARIFFS

President says European talks are ‘going nowhere’

BY DAVID J. LYNCH, ELLEN FRANCIS AND MICHAEL BIRNBAUM

President Donald Trump threatened Friday to impose steep new tariffs on the Apple iPhone and all goods from the European Union, in a move that could put additional pressure on consumer prices and trigger new financial market upheaval if he carries it out.

Before 8 a.m. in Washington, the president fired off a pair of social media posts criticizing Tim Cook, Apple’s chief executive, and European trade practices. Trump said if Apple refused to shift iPhone production from India and other nations to the United States, “a tariff of at least 25% must be paid by Apple to the U.S.”

He also criticized European diplomats as being “very difficult to deal with” and said trade talks were “going nowhere!”

As a result, Trump said he was “recommending a straight 50% tariff on the European Union, starting on June 1.” Speaking to reporters in the Oval Office later in the day, he said the new smartphone taxes would take effect at the end of June and would apply to Samsung and other companies, as well as Apple.

SEE TRUMP ON A10

U.S. Steel: President announces a “partnership” with Nippon. **A12**



COURTESY OF DALE EARNHARDT JR.

Dale Earnhardt Jr. was 26 when his father was killed in a crash at the Daytona 500 at the age of 49.

Chasing ghosts with a racing legend

Nearing the age of his dad’s death, Earnhardt Jr. went looking for answers

BY KENT BABB

MOORESVILLE, N.C. — For as long as he can remember, Dale Earnhardt Jr. has had a recurring dream. He’s at some racetrack, in a garage or the pits, and there’s his daddy talking to some guys.

Dale Sr. is in flannel and jeans, like he just came off the farm. He looks the same as the day he died:

eyes still narrow, hair just as dark, creases rippling off his mustache like rings in a pond. Junior wants to walk toward him, maybe ask a question that’s been percolating for years.

But he can’t move. “I want to go, ‘Hey!’ But that’s not working,” he says. “I’m as close as I can get.”

Ancient civilizations believed

dreams were spiritual rendezvous points where the dead could check in on the living. Until recently, Junior says, he could count on one of these visits about once a year. And since he’s not allowed at his dad’s actual grave, he always tries to avoid waking up.

He just stands there, watching and listening, for as long as he can. SEE EARNHARDT ON A6

For U.S. Jews, killings deepen resolve — or fear

D.C. shooting renews complicated questions of safety and identity

BY MICHELLE BOORSTEIN, EMILY WAX-THIBODEAUX, MOLLY HENNESSY-FISKE AND RACHEL HATZIPANAGOS

For Rabbi Ruth Balinsky Friedman, who teaches Jewish text at a D.C.-area high school, the killings of two Israeli Embassy workers this week have deepened the isolation she’s felt as an American Jew in recent years.

Hamas’s attack on Israel on Oct. 7, 2023, and Israel’s subsequent attacks on Gaza, followed by divisions around the world over what caused the conflict and who was at fault, left the 40-year-old mother of three feeling confused, with no easy solution to the war in sight. Now, after the shooting at the Capital Jewish Museum on Wednesday, she feels similarly disoriented.

“Where do we as a people belong?” she said. “Where do I belong?” And if Jews belong in America, “why are people shooting us in broad daylight?”

Late Wednesday evening, Yaron Lischinsky, 30, and Sarah Lynn Milgrim, 26, were shot after attending a Young Diplomats Reception hosted by the American Jewish Committee at the Capital

Jewish Museum. The alleged shooter shouted “Free, free Palestine” before police took him into custody.

For many Jewish Americans across the country, the shooting near the D.C. museum has reinforced a sense that they’re unsafe — not safe to wear a yarmulke and not safe to go into Jewish institutional buildings, no matter how much is spent on security. For others, the attack on the young couple fueled their strength and confidence — in their faith, in their connection to Israel, in their visible Jewishness. And for yet others, May 21 was just another sad, complicated day to be an American Jew.

The Jewish community has invested many millions in securing its buildings. What does it mean, Friedman said, that people could still be murdered right on the sidewalk?

She felt “tremendous sadness” after “seeing the tragic loss of life and in such a senseless way,” she said. The couple was attending an event about humanitarian causes, including Gaza, she noted. “They were fighting for the thing this shooter thought he was supporting.”

According to the Pew Research SEE SHOOTING ON A4

Flash point: Trump links killings to antisemitism on campuses. **A4**

In D.C.: Police and synagogues beef up security amid climate of fear. **B1**

IN THE NEWS

‘Crypto president’ Donald Trump dined at a black-tie gala with top purchasers of his meme coin, with the White House saying the event posed no ethics concerns. **A12**

Green in a sea of red Kermit the Frog delivered the University of Maryland’s commencement address. **B1**

THE NATION **FEMA faces a backlog** of emergency aid requests as hurricane season approaches. **A2** **Concerns grow** as Trump deports some migrants and expedites protections of others. **A3**

THE WORLD **A 443-foot** shipping vessel ran aground in Norway, narrowly missing a man’s home. **A9** **Fifteen aid trucks** were looted in Gaza as they headed to bakeries, U.N. officials said. **A10**

THE ECONOMY **Cyberdefense cuts** could impair a proposal to ratchet up the U.S. response to China hacks, experts said. **A11** **The DOJ said** it will seek the dismissal of a criminal case against Boeing in connection with two fatal 737 Max crashes. **A12**

THE REGION **Mayor Bowser** vowed legislation to expand juvenile curfew after reports of youths swarming parts of D.C. **B1**

OBITUARIES **Michael Ledeen**, 83, held “a key role” in establishing contacts for the illegal Iran-contra arms deal. **B1**

STYLE **After the diagnosis** for Joe Biden made news, Jake Tapper’s book tour was back to business at D.C.’s 9:30 Club. **C1**

SPORTS **The Nationals’** Keibert Ruiz hadn’t played in front of his parents as a pro. Until an emotional night at Nats Park. **D1**

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